

Clysha Sallice Whitlow

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Professional Summary

Community engagement strategist with over 7 years of designing inclusive outreach approaches, facilitating cross-sector partnerships, and translating technical information into accessible community-centered communications. Experienced in building engagement standards and tools, coordinating multi-partner outreach, and ensuring community voice shapes organizational decision-making. Skilled in stakeholder relationship management, public meeting facilitation, and designing engagement strategies grounded in participatory principles.

Core Competencies

Community Engagement Strategy and Outreach | Stakeholder Relationship Management | Public Meeting and Event Facilitation | Accessible Communication and Message Translation | Coalition Building and Cross-Sector Collaboration | Community Feedback Analysis and Reporting | IAP2 framework | ArcGIS and GIS Tools

Relevant Experience

Community Relations Specialist | Charlotte-Mecklenburg Community Relations Department (Community Affairs Division) – City of Charlotte | 2026-Present

- Created a community survey question bank and deployment guide across four engagement focus areas, standardizing how staff gather resident input
- Developing relational community engagement strategy and implementation timeline, shifting the department from project-based outreach to sustained community presence
- Designing a quarterly stakeholder engagement series to strengthen relationships with community-based organizations and establish a sustained feedback loop between the department and trusted neighborhood partners

Resource Coordinator | Employee Rental Assistance Program – City of Charlotte | 2024–2026

- Managed 120 applicant screenings and \$105K in rental assistance to 27 City employees, achieving 100% housing placement rate at time of disbursement
- Coordinated multi-partner referral pathways with Crisis Assistance Ministry, Housing Collaborative, and Common Wealth Charlotte, ensuring ineligible applicants connected to alternative housing resources
- Designed performance tracking systems that documented program outcomes and informed resource allocation decisions across multiple City departments
- Conducted public presentations and outreach across 10 City department meetings, translating program eligibility and resources into accessible information for various employee audiences

- Partnered with United Way UPSTREAM initiative and A Home For All framework, connecting individual support to community-wide prevention strategy

Community Engagement & Evaluation Consultant | City of Charlotte, Urban Institute, United Way, place-based community NGOs | 2023–Present

- Conduct program evaluations and performance assessments to support organizational decision-making, funding strategies, and continuous improvement.
- Developed ArcGIS StoryMap for City of Charlotte Staying in Place program, translating Charlotte's history of inequitable divestment and pilot areas into public-facing dissemination tool
- Condensed 60-page Urban Institute evaluation report into accessible 8-page brief used at community events and with city/county leadership, program participants, and staff
- Built logic models for various place-based non-profits, including Fearless Black Girls, A Tribe Mentoring, and Sojourner Truth Place

Data and Evaluation Research Assistant – Renaissance West Community Initiative | 2023-2024

- Designed and led community recruitment strategy yielding 100+ survey responses making it the highest participation rate in three years
- Co-led resident and staff feedback sessions that empowered resident leaders as active recruiters and survey assistants, strengthening community ownership of engagement
- Created two-sided infographic translating community data into accessible public-facing format; led door-to-door distribution to reach residents directly
- Developed college and career readiness engagement tool for graduating high school seniors; findings informed partner strategy for aligned career pathway development

Health Program Supervisor (Grant Contract/Student Staff) – Mecklenburg County Office of Violence Prevention | 2022-2023

- Co-facilitated monthly Community Violence Prevention Coalition meetings alongside resident co-leaders, strengthening cross-sector advocacy, research, and resource sharing across 20+ member organizations and community leaders
- Designed member capacity assessment survey and geospatial dashboard created to inform coalition working group structure, funding eligibility decisions, and technical assistance priorities
- Analyzed community survey, focus group, and key informant interview data; trained OVP staff on qualitative analysis methods and developed training manual to build long-term evaluation capacity
- Contributed community-driven data analysis to county-wide adopted strategic plan "The Way Forward: Mecklenburg County Community Violence Strategic Plan (FY2023-FY2028)"

- Developed GIS distribution tracking tool for Gun Violence Awareness Month campaign, mapping 1,500 lockboxes distributed across 15 Mecklenburg County zip codes

Education

PhD (ABD), Health Psychology, Community Concentration – University of North Carolina at Charlotte | 2020–Expected Summer 2026

MA, Psychology – North Carolina Central University | 2018-2020

BS, Rehabilitation Services & Psychology – East Carolina University | 2012-2016